Challenge: Find me!

Narrative

Project Hail Mary - Lost signal

Contact with the Hail Mary mission has gone dark.

Classified Astrophage research is locked across three remote systems named after stellar bodies from the mission. Your team has been given limited network access to the mission relay grid. Recover the data before the transmission window closes.

Objective

The goal of this challenge is to find a flag (Format: FLAG{…}) somewhere on the network.

Backstory

Your team has been contracted to investigate the Hail Mary mission network—an isolated system once used by a crew of three. Each member maintained their own machine, and whatever secrets remain are likely scattered across those systems.

Fortunately, you have an inside source.

One of the crew members, known to his colleagues as **ryland**, has quietly provided intel. According to him, a potentially valuable clue lies buried in an old email he received prior to the mission. He's also done you one better: a backdoor into the network is already in place.

Your objective is clear: gain access, pivot through the network, and recover anything of value.

To enter the mission network, execute the following command:

sudo ip route add 10.7.<N>.0/24 via <HOST IP>

- <N> = your team number (matches your role on the class Discord)
- <HOST IP> = provided at the start of the challenge
- Once executed, 10.7.<N>.0/24 is your target network

Hint

Please note that the command above is not a permanent command. Your system will revert its routing table back to the default if you reboot your computer or restart your networking services. If you are forced to do so, please re-execute the command above.

When you believe you've uncovered the secret, ping your instructor. If you get truly stuck, they can provide a hint.

As a challenge deliverable, upload a ZIP file containing the following items to Canvas:

(1) A `pdf` document that provides a thorough summary of your team's completion of the challenge. The document must include:
   - the steps you took to solve the challenge and all information obtained during that process;
   - the time at which you were able to identify the secret;
   - a description of **each** team member's contributions. Please note that each team member should contribute their own paragraph to this section.

(2) copies of any scripts or programs that you wrote to help in the process;

(3) any tags or options you used when running your scripts

You will be graded on how well you:

(1) Document your process (45%);

(2) How far you were able to get, and how you got there (50%)

(3) Submitted all required files (5%).

Good luck.